



Desperate measures for silicon

Desperate times call for desperate measures. Corporations are now scavenging silicon from washing machines. <https://digit.in/may22-21>



RIP macOS server

Apple has officially discontinued the now almost unsupported macOS Server. <https://digit.in/may22-22>

Hack, tricks and explainer videos

Please... stop.

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

H

ere are five ways to make your PC 5000x faster. Use my “simple” advice and turn your office space into a productivity station. And, what’s the trick? Buy supplies worth twice as much as your home. This is what the world of life hacks and explainer videos has come down to. I can still recall the good old days when every video platform was not filled with a hot pile of garbage like the videos of today.

I don’t mean to Boo honest creators who are putting in actual effort and research into what they are putting out as content to help make the lives of their fellow ‘netizens’ better in some little way. My grudge is against those who put to use a feature film’s budget to make a 15-minute video littered with useless information, which can potentially even cause harm if used without some rational consideration.

In my time working with and around gadgets, even I have found a small section of this category of videos to be helpful. But most videos that are being produced today are nothing short of garbage. First of all, what bothers me about these videos is the lack of depth in the methods suggested in the videos. There will be a video showing how to execute a command in 25 seconds to make the computer faster. But it will skip all the 500 other steps that precedes pressing the enter button after typing a line of code into the command prompt. If it was not for my sense to double-check what this self-proclaimed Tech God was suggesting me to do, I would have wrecked about a dozen of my gadgets.

Next, why would you want anyone to do things that a professional should

do? Machines are complex. One wrong touch of a screwdriver, and it would go kaput and fry the brains of the person holding the darn screwdriver. Who will tell these guide creators on the internet that while their argument in favour of the right to repair movement is completely fair, it is not everyone’s cup of tea to crack open and modify their machines? Sometimes, just using a gadget as it was out of the box is enough for many people. These video people will make ‘false’ promises, and some innocent people would end up with a pile of PCBs and buttons about which they have no clue whatsoever.



Even if an educated and aptly skilled person is watching one of these videos, I can guarantee that only one out of a dozen hacks suggested in the videos would actually benefit the performance of the device. Even if it does help, it will require modifications that would either void your warranty or cost you a fortune to get through in the first place. At that point, one would literally be better off buying an actual upgrade for their device. AND FOR GOODNESS’ SAKE... PLEASE STOP SUGGESTING, EVEN IN A SARCASTIC MANNER THAT WINDOWS USERS CAN DELETE System 32, WITHOUT CAUSING ANY HARM, AND FREE UP SPACE!

Enough of bashing the gadget optimising people. In the limited space that I have left, I will just share some of my own thoughts about the

ones that produce life hack videos. My one and only question to them is, why would I destroy a functional object to create another one, which I could literally buy for a fraction of the object that you are asking me to obliterate? Why?

Also, why can’t two different outlets produce content on their own. It almost seems like the video platforms these days are like an exam hall which has no invigilator. Everyone, every single outlet, is making more or less the same ‘DIY’ video to make your life better. And they are posing as if no one in the world could have thought about how a plastic bottle can be cut in half to be used as a pen stand. Is there any place where I can lodge a formal request asking these people to stop making the same thing in different ways? I will do that no matter what the cost. I am sure it would be better to have five different, decently informational videos rather than a cesspool of the same repeated crap posted again and again disguised as fresh and original content. Also, when making these videos, please spare a thought for the environment. The amount of waste I see being generated in the making of such horrendous pieces of content is more than my residential complex would generate in a week.

If you are someone who makes explainer videos, my only request to you is please do some research before you start blabbering the technical jargon, which anyone can find using a single Google search. The users come to you seeking ways in which they can get from point A to point B in their course of solving a problem. What they get is a long, never-ending flex about the knowledge that you have on the subject, which more often than not is just read 15 minutes before the start of a recording from a Wikipedia page! 